



AN INITIATIVE OF JAMIAT ULAMA-I-HIND

ANNUAL REPORT · 2025

Justice and Empowerment of Minorities

Documenting hate crimes and
targeted discrimination against
minority communities in India.



Justice and Empowerment of Minorities

An initiative of Jamiat Ulama-i-Hind · New Delhi

This Annual Report is published by Justice and Empowerment of Minorities (JEM), an initiative of Jamiat Ulama-i-Hind. It presents a consolidated record of hate crimes and targeted discrimination against minority communities in India during the calendar year 2025, compiled through field documentation, media monitoring, and review by JEM's Case Review Committee (CRC).

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Acronyms and abbreviations

JEM	Justice and Empowerment of Minorities	BNSS	Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita
CRC	Case Review Committee	UCC	Uniform Civil Code
FIR	First Information Report	BJP	Bharatiya Janata Party
BNS	Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita	RSS	Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh
VHP	Vishwa Hindu Parishad		

A complete glossary of analytical terms used in this report appears in Appendix A.

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SECTION 1

Executive Summary

IN THIS SECTION

1.1 Introduction

1.2 Context of Rising Hate Crimes

1.3 Challenges and JEM's Response

1.4 Report at a Glance

In 2025, conspiracy narratives such as “Love Jihad,” “Land Jihad,” “Population Jihad,” and “Vote Jihad” became increasingly common in public discourse, fuelling suspicion and hostility toward minority communities — particularly Muslims — and deepening social polarization across the country.

1.1 Introduction

The 2025 Annual Report of the Justice and Empowerment of Minorities (JEM), an initiative of Jamiat Ulama-i-Hind, presents a comprehensive assessment of hate crimes and targeted discrimination against minority communities in India. During the year, a noticeable rise was observed in incidents of violence, intimidation, and discrimination affecting Muslims, Dalits, Christians, Sikhs, and Tribal communities across different parts of the country.

This report seeks to systematically document these incidents, analyse the factors contributing to their rise, and examine the broader social, political, and cultural conditions in which such acts occur. Alongside presenting verified data and field-based observations, the report aims to strengthen informed public discussion and support policy measures that uphold the rights, dignity, and security of vulnerable communities.

1.2 Context of Rising Hate Crimes

The rise in hate crimes in India has increasingly been linked to the growth of radical religious extremist groups and the spread of divisive narratives. Several studies and reports indicate a noticeable increase in religion-based hate crimes and hate speech after the Narendra Modi-led Bharatiya Janata Party government came to power in 2014. According to the Ballard Brief, nearly 90% of recorded religion-based hate crimes between 2009 and 2019 occurred after 2014, while incidents of hate speech reportedly increased sharply during the same period.^[1]

In 2025, conspiracy narratives such as “Love Jihad,” “Land Jihad,” “Population Jihad,” and “Vote Jihad” became widely circulated in public discourse and social media. These narratives largely targeted the Muslim community by portraying it as a threat to demographic balance, cultural identity, land ownership, and electoral outcomes. The repeated spread of such misinformation contributed to growing communal tensions and, in many cases, appeared to legitimize discrimination, exclusion, and violence in the name of protecting national or cultural interests.

The situation has been further aggravated by weak accountability mechanisms and inconsistent legal action against hate speech and violence. In several cases, delayed investigations and limited prosecution have created a perception of impunity, allowing extremist rhetoric and mob violence to continue with little fear of consequences. This environment has deepened insecurity among minority communities and increased their vulnerability to targeted attacks and social exclusion.

1.3 Challenges and JEM's Response

The rise in hate crimes against minority communities in India reflects deep social divisions, growing political polarization, and institutional weaknesses. These incidents not only create fear and insecurity but also damage social harmony and weaken trust between communities.

One major challenge is the lack of timely justice. Many cases face long judicial delays, while police and administrative responses are often inconsistent. In several instances, complaints are filed but not properly investigated, allowing a sense of impunity to grow. Many incidents also go unreported, especially in rural areas where victims fear retaliation or lack access to legal support.

Media coverage is another concern. While some incidents receive attention on social media, mainstream reporting is often uneven. Cases from marginalized or remote regions frequently remain ignored, limiting public awareness and reducing pressure for accountability. Social and economic inequalities further increase vulnerability among minority communities; discrimination in education, employment, and access to justice contributes to exclusion and insecurity, and in some affected areas, fear and repeated violence have also led to migration and declining trust between communities.

In response to these challenges, JEM, under the guidance of Jamiat Ulama-i-Hind, works to document, analyse, and address hate crimes through research, legal intervention, and advocacy. A key part of this effort is the Case Review Committee (CRC), which includes legal experts, researchers, journalists, and community representatives. The committee verifies incidents, studies patterns of violence, examines media narratives, and analyses possible legal violations under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

JEM also studies the spread of hate narratives, misinformation, and online content that may contribute to violence. Through data analysis and regional mapping, the organization aims to identify high-risk areas and encourage preventive action. Alongside documentation, JEM advocates for stronger hate-crime laws, faster judicial processes, and better enforcement of existing legal protections, and has proposed a Victim Compensation and Rehabilitation Fund to support survivors and affected families.

Through reports, research, and engagement with civil society and constitutional institutions, JEM seeks to strengthen accountability, promote justice, and support peaceful coexistence. This report aims not only to record incidents but also to encourage long-term reforms that uphold dignity, equality, and constitutional values.

1.4 Report at a Glance

The figures below summarise the headline findings of this report. JEM-documented incidents (1,660) combined with 307 incidents drawn from external partner datasets together account for the 1,967 verified incidents referenced throughout; see Section 3 for the full reconciliation.

1,967

Verified incidents documented in 2025

+109%

Increase over the previous reporting year

81.65%

Of incidents targeted the Muslim community

32.17%

Of incidents recorded in Uttar Pradesh

641

Incidents in Q4 2025 — the year's highest

27.11%

Of incidents received mainstream media coverage

ON THE RECORD

A record exists to be cited. Every figure in this report is sourced and dated; counts not otherwise attributed are drawn from JEM's Case Review Committee database (see Section 2.3).



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SECTION 2

About This Report

IN THIS SECTION

2.1 About Justice and Empowerment of Minorities

2.2 Objectives and Scope of the Study

2.3 Methodology

2.1 About Justice and Empowerment of Minorities (JEM)

Justice and Empowerment of Minorities (JEM) is an initiative of Jamiat Ulama-i-Hind dedicated to documenting, analysing, and responding to hate crimes and targeted discrimination against minority communities in India. JEM's work integrates field-based documentation, legal intervention, and policy advocacy, anchored by the interdisciplinary Case Review Committee (CRC), which verifies incidents and examines patterns of violence, media narratives, and possible violations of law.

Beyond documentation, JEM advocates for stronger hate-crime legislation, faster judicial processes, and more consistent enforcement of existing legal protections. It has proposed a Victim Compensation and Rehabilitation Fund to support survivors and affected families, and engages with civil society networks, constitutional institutions, and, where relevant, international human rights forums to advance accountability and the protection of minority rights within India's constitutional framework.

2.2 Objectives and Scope of the Study

JEM undertook a comprehensive and systematic effort to document, analyse, and respond to hate crimes against minority communities in India during 2025, grounded in the recognition that hate crimes are not isolated incidents but manifestations of deeper structural inequalities, ideological contestations, and institutional limitations. The objectives of this report are accordingly multidimensional.

1 Comprehensive and verifiable documentation

Establishing a credible, verifiable record of hate crimes — each incident detailing the nature of the violation, its frequency, intensity, geography, and impact on affected individuals and communities.

2 Public awareness and democratic accountability

Presenting data in a rigorous, accessible format to enhance public awareness among citizens, policymakers, civil society, and media regarding the scale and lived experience of hate crimes.

3 Measuring human, social, and economic impact

Examining consequences beyond the quantitative — psychological trauma, disruption to education, employment and healthcare, economic loss, displacement, and community fragmentation.

4 Analysis of hate narratives and anti-minority sentiment

Analysing the narratives and belief systems that normalise hate, including hate speech, symbolic exclusion, and conspiracy-based rhetoric portraying minorities as threats.

5 Mapping patterns, trends, and structural drivers

Undertaking geospatial and temporal mapping to identify recurring trends — including fluctuations during elections and religious events — and structural drivers such as socioeconomic inequality.

6 Political rhetoric, policy, and governance analysis

Examining the relationship between political discourse, public policy, and social tension — including content analysis of speeches and legislative measures — and evaluating governance responses.

7 Media and digital ecosystem assessment

Analysing traditional and digital platforms for bias, omission, or sensationalism, and the role of digital platforms in amplifying or countering hate speech.

8 Examination of systemic and institutional dimensions

Critically examining systemic inequalities and institutional practices that contribute to differential access to justice, and how they intersect with caste, religion, ethnicity, and gender.

9 Legal reform and policy advocacy

Proposing policy recommendations to strengthen protections — including comprehensive hate-crime legislation and victim-centred approaches prioritising prevention, accountability, and restorative justice.

10 Accountability, transparency, and justice mechanisms

Advocating for transparent investigations, timely registration of cases, and appropriate legal consequences, ensuring state and non-state actors are subject to the rule of law.

11 Legal aid, rehabilitation, and victim support

Supporting survivors through pro bono legal networks, court representation, humanitarian assistance, and long-term psychosocial support and community reintegration.

METHOD

These eleven objectives frame the analysis that follows — documentation first, then the social, political, and institutional conditions in which incidents occur, and finally the reforms they call for.

2.3 Methodology

To ensure the integrity, credibility, and analytical depth of this report, JEM adopted a comprehensive, multi-source, and multidisciplinary research methodology, combining extensive data collection, systematic verification, and layered analysis.

Data collection and sources

Data were drawn from a diverse range of sources to ensure breadth, reliability, and cross-verification — including national and regional print media, digital news platforms, television broadcasts, and reports from civil society organizations and community networks. JEM also conducted systematic monitoring of digital platforms to document incidents, hate speech, and narratives that may precede or accompany offline violence. Where available, audio-visual material from publicly accessible platforms was examined to corroborate reported incidents, particularly to address gaps in official reporting in rural and marginalized regions.

Quantitative and qualitative analysis

Each documented incident was subjected to a two-tier analytical framework. Quantitative analysis assessed the scale, frequency, geographical distribution, and temporal patterns of hate crimes, enabling identification of trends and possible correlations with political, social, or religious developments. Qualitative analysis complemented these findings by situating incidents within their broader social and political contexts, drawing on survivor testimonies, eyewitness accounts, and media narratives to capture the lived human impact underlying the data.

Case Review Committee (CRC)

A central component of JEM's methodology is the Case Review Committee (CRC), an interdisciplinary body responsible for ensuring that each incident included in the report undergoes rigorous scrutiny prior to documentation. The committee comprises professionals with the following areas of expertise.

Table 2.1 — Case Review Committee composition

Role	Contribution to the review process
Legal Expert (Lawyer)	Provides legal assessment of each incident within the framework of Indian law, including identification of relevant statutory provisions and evaluation of law enforcement and judicial responses.
Researcher	Ensures methodological robustness by validating data accuracy, identifying thematic patterns, and situating incidents within broader socio-political contexts.
Community Representative	Contributes insights from engagement with affected communities, helping to contextualize incidents in terms of lived experience, including displacement and social exclusion.
Digital & Social Media Analyst	Examines online content related to incidents, including patterns of hate speech, misinformation, and digital mobilization.
Journalist / Media Analyst	Assesses media coverage of incidents, including accuracy, framing, omissions, and potential bias.

Each case undergoes a structured process of review and deliberation: members evaluate available evidence, cross-verify sources, and discuss classification and contextual interpretation. Incidents are included only after a reasonable level of verification is achieved and consensus is reached regarding their credibility and categorization — a collective process designed to minimize errors, reduce bias, and ensure each documented case reflects a balanced, well-substantiated account.

Ethical considerations and reporting standards

JEM's methodology is guided by principles of ethical research and responsible reporting. Particular attention is given to safeguarding the dignity, privacy, and security of affected individuals; sensitive information is handled with care, and efforts are made to avoid traumatization or unintended harm through documentation practices. The methodology emphasizes transparency, accuracy, and accountability, while remaining attentive to the limitations inherent in documenting underreported and sensitive phenomena such as hate crimes.

A note on sourcing and attribution

Unless a specific external source is cited in the text, the incident counts, percentages, and classifications presented throughout this report are JEM's own findings, drawn from the Case Review Committee (CRC) database compiled through the field documentation, FIR tracking, and digital monitoring process described above. Where this report draws on external research, partner datasets, or third-party reporting, the source is cited inline (e.g., ^[1]) and listed in full in Appendix L. Attributions of responsibility to named individuals, groups, or organizations reflect JEM's own classification based on field documentation and public reporting; except where a conviction or finding is explicitly noted, these attributions have not been independently adjudicated by a court of law.

ON THE RECORD

A figure that cannot be corroborated is held outside the published totals and marked accordingly.
Verified · entered into record.

Limitations of the study

While the report adopts a rigorous methodology, certain limitations must be acknowledged, including the possibility of underreporting, uneven availability of data across regions, and reliance on secondary sources in some cases. Establishing direct causality between rhetoric, policy, and specific incidents may also be complex due to the multifaceted nature of social dynamics. Recognizing these constraints, the report aims to provide a carefully verified and analytically grounded representation of documented trends, rather than an exhaustive account of all incidents.

A specific limitation concerns the differential visibility of incidents across communities. The lower incident counts recorded for Sikhs, Tribal communities, and, to a lesser extent, Christians and Dalits (see Section 3) should not be read as evidence that these communities experience proportionately less hate-motivated harm. Rather, they reflect current gaps in JEM's documentation reach — including uneven media coverage, limited community-level reporting networks, and language or access barriers in certain regions — rather than the actual absence or rarity of such incidents. JEM treats this as a methodological gap rather than a finding about relative risk, and has identified the expansion of community-specific reporting channels, particularly within Sikh and Adivasi communities, as a priority area for strengthening future editions.

Commitment to accuracy and evidence-based analysis

Through this structured, multidisciplinary approach, JEM reaffirms its commitment to ethical documentation, factual accuracy, and evidence-based analysis, reflecting its broader objective of contributing to informed public discourse, strengthening accountability, and supporting policy interventions through credible and systematically verified data.



3

SECTION 3

National Overview: Hate Crimes in 2025

IN THIS SECTION

3.1 Victim Community Distribution

3.2 Quarterly and Geographic Patterns

3.3 Community-Wise Analysis

3.4 Synthesis and Way Forward

The pattern of hate crimes documented in this report reveals a pronounced asymmetry in victimization across India's minority communities. Muslims, followed by Dalits, Christians, and other marginalized groups, bear a disproportionate share of documented incidents. These patterns cannot be understood as isolated occurrences; rather, they are situated within broader dynamics of identity politics, social polarization, and institutional limitations.

Drawing upon verified field documentation, legal tracking, and digital monitoring, JEM recorded a total of 1,967 hate-related incidents in 2025 — a 109 percent increase compared to the previous reporting year. This figure combines 1,660 incidents documented directly through JEM's quarterly review process (see Section 7) with 307 incidents drawn from external partner datasets compiled by the United Christian Forum^[2] and Citizens for Justice and Peace^[3], comprising 192 cases involving Christians, 113 cases involving Dalits, and 2 cases involving Sikhs.

3.1 Victim Community Distribution

Muslims were the primary targets, accounting for 81.65 percent (1,606 incidents) of all documented cases. Other affected communities include Christians at 10.78 percent (212 incidents), Scheduled Castes (Dalits) and Tribals at 7.52 percent (148 incidents), and Sikhs at 0.10 percent (2 incidents). The qualitative evidence suggests the persistence of low-intensity hostility, including stigmatizing rhetoric and online harassment, which often remains under-reported.

Table 3.1 — Documented incidents by victim community, 2025

Community	Incidents	Share of total
Muslims	1,606	81.65%
Christians	212	10.78%
Scheduled Castes (Dalits) & Tribals	148	7.52%
Sikhs	2	0.10%
Total	1,967*	100%

**Total reflects 1,660 incidents documented directly through JEM's quarterly review combined with 307 incidents from external partner datasets (United Christian Forum; Citizens for Justice and Peace).*

A NOTE ON THESE FIGURES

The smaller numbers recorded for Sikhs, Tribal communities, and — to a lesser extent — Christians and Dalits reflect gaps in JEM's current documentation reach, not the absence or rarity of hate-motivated harm against these communities. Strengthening community-specific reporting channels for these groups is a priority for future editions (see Section 2.3).

3.2 Quarterly and Geographic Patterns

A quarter-wise analysis reveals that the pattern of violence was not episodic but sustained throughout the year. The first quarter (January–March) recorded 387 incidents, followed by 265 in the second quarter (April–June). The third quarter (July–September) saw 367 incidents, often linked to religious processions and localized tensions. A significant escalation occurred in the fourth quarter (October–December), with 641 incidents associated with festival-related violence, administrative actions against religious institutions, and disputes involving waqf properties.

Figure 1 — Quarterly incident trend, 2025

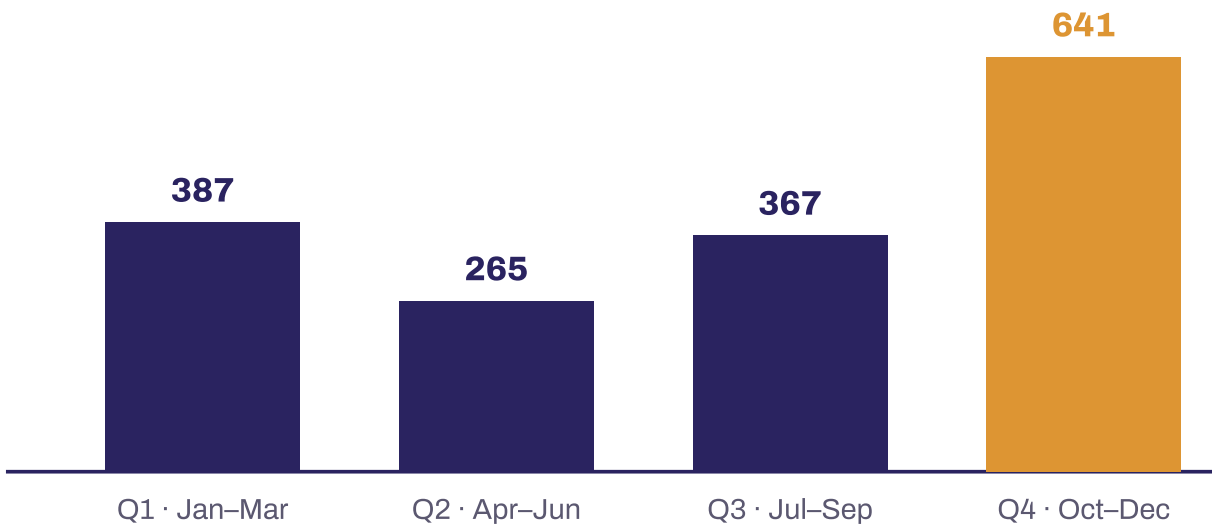


Figure 1 — The final quarter recorded the year's sharpest escalation; saffron marks the peak (see Section 7 for the full quarterly review).

The nature of violations spans a wide spectrum — mob lynching, physical assaults, custodial violence, attacks on religious spaces, discriminatory demolitions, hate speech, and digital incitement. A substantial proportion of cases fail to progress beyond initial complaints, with delayed or absent First Information Reports (FIRs) and limited prosecutorial follow-through raising serious concerns about institutional accountability.

Geospatial analysis identifies Uttar Pradesh as the most affected state, accounting for 32.17 percent (534 incidents) of the total caseload, followed by Maharashtra and other states where political polarization and administrative bias appear to have heightened vulnerabilities. Perpetrator attribution indicates that individuals or groups associated with majoritarian ideological networks were implicated in 86.27 percent of ideologically motivated incidents, suggesting a significant degree of organization in such acts of violence.

Beyond quantitative findings, the report incorporates qualitative narratives drawn from survivor testimonies, community interviews, and field investigations. Its objective is not only to document incidents but to provide a research-driven foundation for policy reform — including strengthening enforcement of provisions such as Section 196 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita relating to hate speech, and improving accountability mechanisms within law enforcement. The analysis is situated within the constitutional framework of equality, non-discrimination, and dignity enshrined in Articles 14, 15, and 16 of the Constitution of India.

In cases where political affiliation could be identified, actors linked to the Bharatiya Janata Party were associated with 428 incidents — 66.8 percent of such identifiable cases — and 80 percent of all documented incidents (1,328 cases) occurred in states governed by the party, patterns that warrant further institutional and scholarly examination. In Uttar Pradesh, approximately 67 percent of cases involved delayed or absent police intervention. Organizations associated with Hindutva-oriented mobilization were also implicated in a subset of incidents: the Bajrang Dal and the Vishwa Hindu Parishad were linked to 50 and 33 incidents respectively (6.20 percent of the total), many associated with vigilante actions including those justified under claims of cow protection. These figures reflect JEM's own classification of identifiable actors named in field reports and public records, except where a conviction is explicitly noted elsewhere.

JEM documented 135 instances of provocative public statements by political actors, particularly in Maharashtra and Uttarakhand, with a proportion of violent incidents appearing to occur in temporal proximity to such rhetoric, although establishing direct causality remains methodologically complex. Hate speech reportedly increased by 109 percent compared to 2024. JEM also documented 180 instances of state-related discrimination (10.84 percent) and 104 incidents involving police excesses — patterns which, if substantiated, carry implications for public trust in institutions and the protection of constitutional rights.

3.3 Community-Wise Analysis

Muslims

Muslims were the most heavily targeted community, accounting for 1,606 incidents (81.65%) of all documented cases. The nature of violations spans a wide spectrum: JEM recorded 512 cases of physical assault and 289 incidents categorized as mob violence, many associated in reporting narratives with vigilantism linked to cow protection, particularly in parts of Uttar Pradesh. In addition, 421 incidents involved damage to or disputes around religious properties, including mosques and madrasas, and the report documents 384 cases of socioeconomic exclusion, such as boycotts of businesses and denial of services.

Digital platforms appear to play a role in the spread of hostile narratives, with messaging platforms such as WhatsApp identified as a channel through which misinformation may circulate ahead of certain incidents, although establishing direct causality remains methodologically complex. Concerns regarding accountability persist, with a substantial proportion of cases not progressing to prosecution in certain states.

Dalits and Tribals

Dalits accounted for 148 incidents (7.52%) of documented cases. While smaller in number compared to religiously targeted incidents, these cases reflect the continuing presence of caste-based discrimination and violence, concentrated in states such as Maharashtra and Bihar — particularly in rural contexts where caste relations intersect with land ownership and labour structures. Documented cases include physical assaults, violence linked to inter-caste relationships, and denial of access to shared resources such as water and land.

Qualitative findings indicate the persistence of structural exclusion — discrimination in employment, barriers within educational institutions, and social boycotts — alongside challenges in the effective enforcement of protective legislation such as the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act. The broader impact includes economic vulnerability, social marginalization, and intersectional disadvantage, particularly for Dalit women.

Tribal Communities (Adivasis)

Tribal communities accounted for a small number of documented incidents, consistent with the documentation gap noted above (Section 3.1) rather than an absence of harm. Most documented cases concern land dispossession, displacement, and administrative action, including a recorded incident of land-related conflict in a forested region that resulted in displacement and associated socioeconomic impacts. Broader civil-society reporting suggests that similar issues — land rights, resource extraction, and displacement — are often insufficiently captured within conventional hate-crime frameworks, raising concerns regarding constitutional protections including those related to Scheduled Areas and forest rights.

Christians

Christians accounted for 212 documented incidents (10.78%). Although limited in number, these indicate localized patterns of religious tension, with a majority of reported cases concentrated in states such as Odisha and Madhya Pradesh. Documented incidents include damage to places of worship, harassment of religious leaders, and instances of social or economic exclusion, with several cases reported in the context of allegations related to religious conversion. JEM's analysis suggests certain incidents were preceded by localized mobilization and the circulation of unverified information; accountability outcomes remain limited, with relatively few cases progressing to conviction.

Sikhs

Sikhs accounted for 2 documented incidents (0.10%). As with Tribal communities, this figure is better read as a reflection of current documentation gaps (Section 3.1) than as evidence that hostility is rare: qualitative inputs from community sources point to ongoing low-intensity hostility, including verbal harassment and online rhetoric, much of it drawing on historical or political themes and rarely formally reported.

3.4 Synthesis and Way Forward

While Muslims accounted for the overwhelming majority (81.65%) of documented incidents, the experiences of Dalits, Christians, Sikhs, and Tribal communities reflect distinct yet interconnected forms of vulnerability shaped by caste, religion, ethnicity, and structural inequality. The findings point toward the need for a multi-layered response:

- Strengthening legal and policy frameworks, including consideration of comprehensive hate-crime legislation and improved enforcement of existing laws;
- Enhancing victim support systems, including compensation, rehabilitation, and access to justice;
- Promoting long-term social interventions — education, community engagement, and efforts to counter misinformation and prejudice.



4

SECTION 4

Typology of Hate Crimes

IN THIS SECTION

4.1 The Seven-Category Classification Framework

The persistent escalation of hate crimes in India represents far more than a numerical increase in reported incidents; it reflects a deeper erosion of the country's constitutional commitment to pluralism, equality, and fraternity. These incidents disproportionately targeted religious minorities — particularly Muslims and Christians — as well as Scheduled Castes (Dalits), Scheduled Tribes (Adivasis), and other intersectionally vulnerable groups, including women, migrant labourers, and economically marginalized communities.

In response, JEM has developed a comprehensive framework for classifying hate crimes based on field documentation, survivor accounts, and interdisciplinary consultation. The framework recognizes hate crimes as part of a continuum — from symbolic hostility to physical violence and structural discrimination — comprising seven interrelated categories designed to capture overlapping forms of harm.

4.1 The Seven-Category Classification Framework

The classification and percentages below reflect JEM's Case Review Committee coding of the 1,660 incidents documented directly through its quarterly review process; full category definitions appear in Appendix B.

Figure 2 — Seven-category classification, 2025 (ranked by volume)

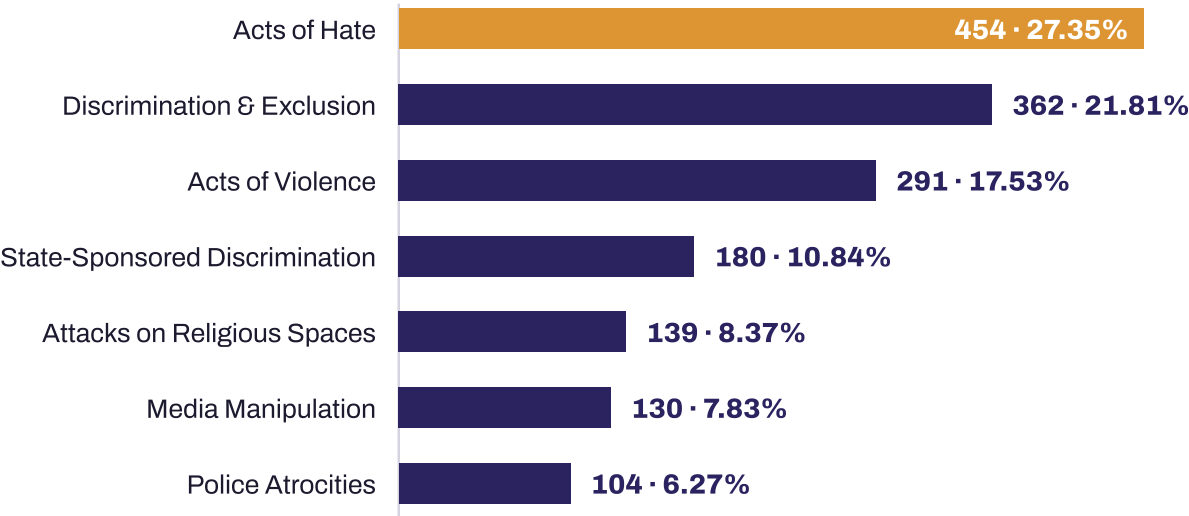


Figure 2 — Acts of Hate form the single largest category (saffron); percentages are shares of the 1,660 directly documented incidents.

Table 4.1 — Incidents by category, 2025

Category	Incidents	Share
a) Acts of Hate	454	27.35%
b) Acts of Violence	291	17.53%
c) Attacks on Religious Spaces	139	8.37%
d) State-Sponsored Discrimination	180	10.84%
e) Police Atrocities	104	6.27%
f) Discrimination, Exclusion & Prejudice	362	21.81%
g) Media Manipulation & Distortion	130	7.83%
Total (seven-category classification)	1,660	100%

The remaining 307 incidents drawn from external partner datasets (see Section 3.1) are reported by community rather than by category.

a) Acts of Hate

Acts of Hate constitute the largest category, accounting for 454 incidents (27.35%). These include verbal abuse, discriminatory behaviour in public and institutional spaces, and coordinated hate speech online. JEM found that approximately 62% of these incidents originated online, particularly through platforms such as WhatsApp and X. Geographically, around 40% were concentrated in major urban centres such as Mumbai and Delhi, while rural districts in Bihar and Uttar Pradesh reflected caste-based variants. Notably, 18% of violent incidents were preceded by documented acts of hate, indicating their role as early-warning indicators.

b) Acts of Violence

Acts of Violence accounted for 291 incidents (17.53%), including assaults, mob violence, arson, and targeted attacks linked to allegations such as “cow slaughter” or “love jihad.” Approximately 71% of victims belonged to Muslim or Dalit communities, with Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra together accounting for about 45% of these incidents. Around 35% occurred during elections and religious festivals, and law-enforcement delays were noted in over half of the cases, contributing to escalation and reduced accountability.

c) Attacks on Religious Spaces

A total of 139 incidents (8.37%) involved attacks on religious spaces, including vandalism, arson, and desecration. Mosques (48%) and churches (22%) were the most affected; Assam and West Bengal together accounted for approximately 31% of such incidents, and around 41% occurred at night, suggesting planned actions. These incidents had broader social impacts, including increased community fear and reduced participation in religious and public life.

d) State-Sponsored Discrimination

This category includes 180 incidents (10.84%) involving discriminatory actions or omissions by state authorities — such as unequal access to welfare, demolition drives, and selective enforcement. Delhi and Madhya Pradesh accounted for around 39% of these cases, and a significant proportion of legal challenges remained unresolved beyond standard timelines, indicating delays in judicial redress.

e) Police Atrocities

JEM recorded 104 incidents (6.27%) of police-related abuses, including custodial violence, arbitrary detention, and alleged extrajudicial actions. Muslims and Adivasis constituted a majority of victims, and a large proportion of cases did not result in convictions, contributing to declining trust in law enforcement among affected communities.

f) Discrimination, Exclusion, and Prejudice

This category accounted for 362 incidents (21.81%), covering systemic discrimination in housing, employment, education, and social participation. Maharashtra and Bihar together represented approximately 52% of cases, highlighting persistent structural inequalities affecting marginalized communities and limiting social mobility.

g) Media Manipulation and Distortion of Facts

JEM identified 130 incidents (7.83%) involving misinformation, selective reporting, and distorted narratives across media platforms. Digital media accounted for a significant share of these cases, and the analysis indicates that a notable proportion of violent incidents were preceded by misinformation spikes, particularly during politically sensitive periods such as elections.



5

SECTION 5

Media and Digital Ecosystem Assessment

IN THIS SECTION

5.1 Breakdown of Media Coverage

5.2 Incidents Not Covered or Recorded

5.3 The Online Space

The national discourse surrounding hate crimes reveals a significant disparity in the manner and extent to which incidents are covered across social media platforms and mainstream media outlets. This imbalance carries substantial implications for public awareness, civic engagement, and institutional accountability, as media visibility plays a decisive role in shaping which incidents attract public attention, mobilize civil-society responses, and prompt timely intervention.

JEM's analysis integrates quantitative data with qualitative insights derived from systematic content audits, survivor testimonies, and longitudinal trend assessment, revealing persistent patterns of underreporting, narrative distortion, and regional as well as demographic bias.

5.1 Breakdown of Media Coverage

Figure 3 — Media engagement across documented incidents, 2025

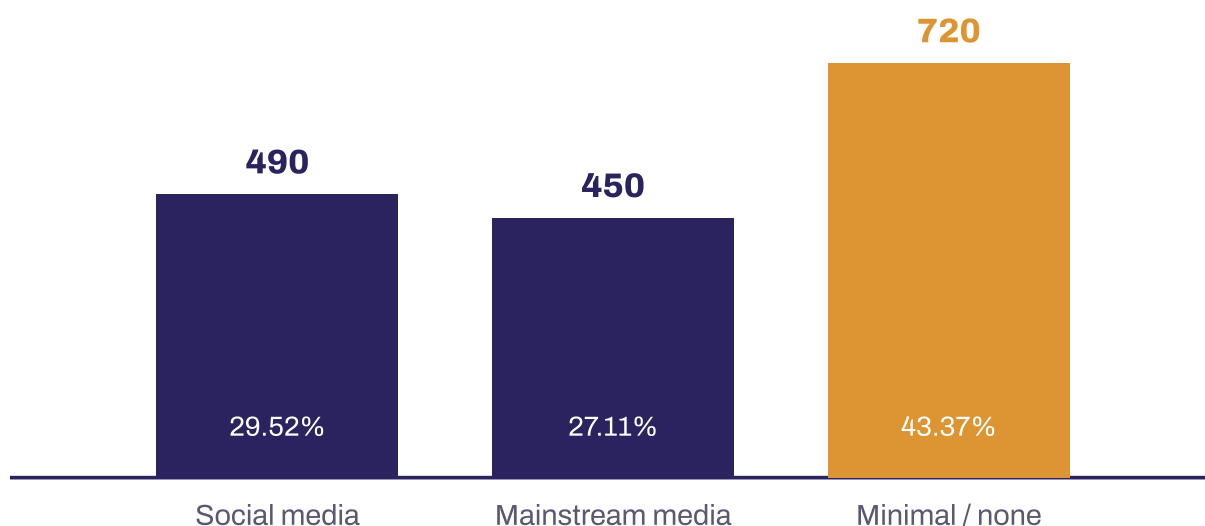


Figure 3 — Nearly 43% of documented incidents received minimal or no coverage (saffron). Categories may overlap where an incident appeared on more than one channel; shares are of the 1,660 directly documented incidents.

a) Social media coverage

Platforms such as X, Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, and YouTube — with their extensive nationwide user base — have fundamentally altered the dynamics of information flow around minority rights, functioning as decentralized repositories of real-time accounts that challenge institutional silence and amplify marginalized voices. Social media has proven particularly consequential in exposing incidents that remain underreported or entirely absent from mainstream news coverage.

JEM's archival analysis, covering posts between January 2025 and January 2026, found that clusters of users collectively generated between 20 and 50 posts per incident. Overall, 490 hate-crime incidents (29.52%) received substantive visibility on social media. Hashtag-based mobilization — including campaigns such as #EndHateNow and #MinorityRightsIndia — generated widespread engagement and, in several cases, contributed to institutional responses such as FIR registration.

The strengths of social media lie in its hyperlocal reach and participatory nature; survivor-led narratives enabled rapid community mobilization, and algorithmic amplification enabled incidents from remote regions, such as Tribal areas in Chhattisgarh, to reach national audiences. However, this visibility is not without limitations: JEM's content audits found that a notable share of posts contained unverified or partially inaccurate information, and algorithmic moderation may disproportionately affect minority-generated content. JEM emphasizes the need for integrated verification frameworks that combine the reach of social media with rigorous fact-checking and ethical reporting standards.

b) Mainstream media coverage

Despite the size and diversity of India's mainstream media ecosystem, systematic reporting on hate crimes during 2025 remained limited. According to the present study's content analysis, only 450 of the 1,967 verified incidents (27.11%) received substantive coverage in mainstream media. A significant share of detailed reporting was concentrated among a limited number of national publications and broadcast platforms; some outlets produced investigative reports on police conduct and economic boycotts, demonstrating the constructive role segments of the media can play in promoting accountability.

However, coverage patterns remained uneven — several outlets relied on syndicated content lacking depth, and broadcast media displayed variation, with some channels framing incidents as generalized “clashes,” obscuring structural factors and accountability. Geographical disparities were also evident: states with high concentrations of incidents did not consistently receive proportionate national attention, particularly in rural and peri-urban areas. With less than one-third of incidents receiving substantive coverage, strengthening independent journalism, expanding regional reporting, and enhancing editorial transparency are essential to ensuring media institutions fulfil their constitutional role.

5.2 Incidents Not Covered or Recorded

Beyond incidents captured through formal complaints and media reporting, a substantial proportion of hate-related harm remains insufficiently visible. In 2025, JEM identified 720 incidents (approximately 43.37%) that received minimal or no coverage across both mainstream and social media. Comparative analysis suggests documented cases may represent only 60–65% of actual occurrences, indicating a possible 35–40% undercount, consistent with patterns observed in previous years.

These underreported incidents include localized harassment, festival-related exclusion, digital hate within closed networks, informal evictions, land dispossession, and economic boycotts. While often non-lethal, these forms of harm generate sustained insecurity and long-term socioeconomic consequences. Multiple factors contribute to underreporting:

Political sensitivity

Media hesitancy in covering politically sensitive issues remains a structural constraint. A significant number of underreported incidents occurred in politically sensitive contexts, where coverage may involve reputational or commercial risks, often resulting in cautious framing, omission of key details, or lack of follow-up reporting.

Geographical and local reporting gaps

Rural and peri-urban areas remain underrepresented due to limited reporting infrastructure. Incidents such as caste-based violence in Bihar and Tribal displacement in central India often lack sustained coverage, with low digital access and limited connectivity further restricting documentation and dissemination.

Editorial bias and newsroom priorities

Editorial decisions significantly shape coverage patterns; some reporting reflects dominant narratives, while incidents affecting marginalized communities receive limited depth or follow-up. Urban-centric priorities and commercial considerations further skew visibility.

Misinformation and verification failures

While social media has expanded reporting, it has also introduced challenges related to misinformation. A portion of online content remains unverified or misleading, and repeated exposure may lead to public fatigue and reduced attention to verified cases, underscoring the importance of strengthening verification systems and media literacy.

CONCLUDING OBSERVATION

The coexistence of selective mainstream coverage, uneven social-media amplification, and widespread invisibility underscores a systemic gap in India's information ecosystem — calling for strengthened protections for journalistic independence, investment in rural reporting, transparent content moderation, and robust fact-checking collaborations between media and civil society.

5.3 The Online Space

Beyond physical geography, the digital ecosystem has emerged as a critical terrain for the proliferation of hate. In 2025, JEM documented 47 incidents (2.83%) that originated or were sustained entirely within online spaces — a 38% increase over the previous reporting period. These were identified through systematic monitoring of X, WhatsApp, Telegram, YouTube, Instagram, and Facebook.

JEM's platform-wise analysis reveals distinct but overlapping modalities of harm. WhatsApp and Telegram functioned primarily as closed-network incubators, facilitating the rapid circulation of misinformation and mobilization messages beyond public scrutiny. X and Facebook served as amplification hubs for hate speech and coordinated harassment, while Instagram and YouTube increasingly emerged as vectors for visual propaganda, including manipulated clips and algorithm-driven content targeting youth audiences.

Content classification indicates that 29% of online-only incidents involved coordinated doxing and harassment campaigns, 41% consisted of incitement-driven memes, reels, and videos, and 30% involved manipulated or deepfake content. Muslims were targeted in 73% of these incidents, followed by Dalits and migrant communities. The anonymity afforded by digital platforms enabled 82% of these incidents to transcend state and, in some cases, national boundaries, significantly complicating jurisdictional accountability.

Temporal correlation analysis reveals that 56% of online hate incidents coincided with offline flashpoints such as religious festivals, elections, or court verdicts. A notable example is the 2025 Diwali disinformation surge in Delhi, where viral videos and reels — many later found to be misleading or fabricated — preceded 12 documented instances of offline retaliatory violence.

The psychosocial consequences of digital hate are substantial: JEM recorded 1,089 reported cases of anxiety, fear, and trauma symptoms linked directly to online harassment, particularly among women, students, and young professionals. Algorithmic recommendation systems on platforms such as YouTube and Instagram were found to play a significant role in youth radicalization pathways, reinforcing echo chambers that normalize exclusionary and violent ideologies.

In response, JEM advocates a multipronged regulatory and technological approach — including platform-specific accountability frameworks, geo-fenced and language-sensitive content moderation, traceability of viral multimedia content, and coordinated hate-flagging protocols across major platforms. Without such interventions, the unchecked spread of digital hate risks further collapsing the boundary between virtual hostility and physical violence.

IN FOCUS

1,089 reported cases of anxiety, fear, and trauma symptoms were linked directly to online harassment in 2025 — concentrated among women, students, and young professionals.



SECTION 6

6 Geographical Distribution and Regional Analysis

IN THIS SECTION

6.1 Regional Concentration of Hate Crimes

6.2 Concluding Implications

The spatial distribution of the 1,967 verified incidents provides critical insight into the structural conditions that facilitate violence, discrimination, and social exclusion. Geography functions not merely as a descriptive variable but as an analytical tool that helps identify patterns related to governance gaps, ideological influence, demographic pressures, and economic vulnerability.

6.1 Regional Concentration of Hate Crimes

Figure 4 — Geographic concentration by share of total incidents, 2025

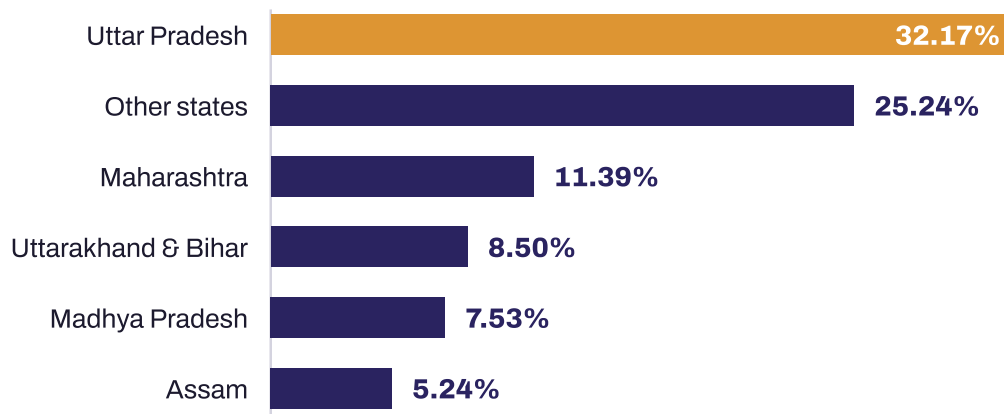


Figure 4 — Uttar Pradesh accounts for the largest single share (saffron). Uttarakhand and Bihar are reported as a combined figure; “other states” includes Gujarat, West Bengal, and Kerala.

The concentration of hate crimes in a limited number of states indicates the presence of structural risk environments rather than a random or evenly distributed pattern. Population density emerges as a significant contributing factor, particularly in Uttar Pradesh — with a population exceeding 240 million — where JEM's internal assessment suggests districts with higher density tend to experience a greater likelihood of conflict as competition over resources, public space, and political influence intensifies social friction.

Governance-related factors may further amplify these risks: variations in policing efficiency, prosecutorial follow-through, and administrative responsiveness appear to influence case progression and accountability. Within high-incidence states, the nature of victimization reflects intersecting social fault lines — in Uttar Pradesh, religious targeting constitutes a significant proportion of incidents, with Muslims forming a large share of affected individuals; in Maharashtra, caste-based violence remains prominent, with a notable proportion of cases involving Dalit victims; and in Madhya Pradesh, incidents linked to land, forest rights, and displacement disproportionately affected Adivasi communities.

These regional dynamics were further influenced by broader economic stressors during 2025, including agrarian distress in several states, which corresponded with a rise in rural incidents. Beyond the primary hotspots, Assam, Uttarakhand, and Bihar also contributed a measurable share, where migration-related anxieties and local identity politics were associated with social exclusion and displacement. The remaining “other states” category, comprising approximately 25.24% of the total, highlights the diffusion of hate beyond traditionally recognized flashpoints — including Gujarat and West Bengal — while emerging patterns in states with historically lower reported incidence, including Kerala, underscore the importance of anticipatory and preventive governance.

6.2 Concluding Implications

The geographical distribution of hate crimes across both physical and digital domains reveals marked regional disparities in exposure to violence, discrimination, and institutional response. These uneven patterns underscore the need for context-specific, place-sensitive interventions that are informed by reliable data, grounded in accountability, and strengthened through sustained community engagement.

JEM emphasizes that responding to these spatial patterns is not limited to strengthening law enforcement; it is fundamentally a constitutional imperative to ensure that access to justice, personal dignity, and security is not determined by geography. JEM calls for coordinated, federated approaches that integrate official crime statistics with civil-society monitoring — enabling granular hotspot identification, proactive law-enforcement engagement, and targeted socio-economic interventions that de-escalate tensions before they evolve into entrenched conflict.



7

SECTION 7

Quarterly Review of 2025

IN THIS SECTION

7.1 Quarter I · January – March

7.2 Quarter II · April – June

7.3 Quarter III · July – September

7.4 Quarter IV · October – December

The pattern of violence documented by JEM in 2025 was sustained rather than episodic, with incidents recorded across all four quarters and a marked escalation in the final quarter.

7.1 Quarter I · January – March

The first quarter witnessed a notable escalation in reported hate crimes and communal tensions. Developments such as the implementation of the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) in Uttarakhand and heightened political rhetoric during religious observances contributed to an environment of increased polarization. JEM documented **387 verified incidents**, including physical assaults, hate speech, damage to religious property, police misconduct, and institutional discrimination.

Key developments

- **Escalation of violence** — mob assaults, custodial deaths, and attacks on interfaith couples, with a noticeable increase in March coinciding with major religious events such as Holi.
- **Targeted demolitions** — approximately 50 incidents involved the demolition of mosques, madrasas, and residential structures in Pune, Haldwani, and parts of Assam, often under anti-encroachment drives; concerns were raised regarding due process.
- **Hate speech by public figures** — inflammatory statements attributed to political figures and ideological influencers, including calls for economic boycotts, appeared to correlate with documented incidents.

Emerging trends

- **Rise in mob violence** — vigilantism, coercive public acts, and processional tensions increased, with Muslims forming a majority of victims and Dalits affected in smaller proportions.
- **Expansion of hate narratives** — themes such as “love jihad” and disputes over religious sites continued to circulate, contributing to online harassment and offline mobilization.

7.2 Quarter II · April – June

The second quarter recorded **265 verified incidents**, indicating continued communal tensions across multiple regions — characterized by physical violence, hate speech, police-related actions, and attacks on religious spaces.

Key developments

- **Escalation of hate speech and violence** — Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh recorded higher numbers, with Muslims constituting a large proportion of affected individuals, particularly in cases involving mob violence and online misinformation.
- **Attacks on religious sites** — vandalism and demolition of mosques, madrasas, and dargahs in Madhya Pradesh (notably Ujjain), Uttar Pradesh, and Maharashtra, often linked to land or encroachment disputes.
- **Discriminatory actions** — instances of biased enforcement or administrative measures raised concerns about unequal application of the law.

Table 7.1 — Quarter II incidents by state

State	Incidents	Share of quarter
Uttar Pradesh	66	24.91%
Madhya Pradesh	29	10.94%
Maharashtra	22	8.30%
Other states	108	40.75%
Total	265	100%

A portion of incidents was associated with political or ideological affiliations, including actors linked to the Bharatiya Janata Party and Hindutva-aligned groups, though a significant number of cases remained unattributed due to reporting limitations. Muslims constituted the majority of victims in documented cases, followed by Dalits and Christians.

7.3 Quarter III · July – September

This quarter recorded **367 verified incidents**, reflecting continued escalation, particularly during major religious observances such as Kanwar Yatra, Muharram, Ganesh Chaturthi, and Milad-un-Nabi.

Key developments

- **Escalation during festivals** — incidents increased during religious events, with Uttar Pradesh, Assam, and Maharashtra reporting higher levels of clashes and mob-related violence.
- **Demolition drives** — multiple instances affecting mosques, madrasas, and homes in Madhya Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and Assam, raising concerns regarding compliance with legal safeguards and judicial guidelines.
- **Hate speech and media influence** — inflammatory rhetoric and selective coverage were observed in several cases, with certain outlets, including Sudarshan News, cited in discussions on media framing and amplification of polarizing narratives.^[4]

Emerging trends

- **Heightened religious polarization** — a significant share of incidents occurred during religious processions and festivals, contributing to symbolic contestations over public spaces.
- **Administrative actions** — evictions and demolitions in areas such as Dhubri (Assam) and Bhopal raised concerns about due process and proportionality.
- **Increased vigilantism** — activity linked to ideological groups, including references to organizations such as the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh, was noted alongside continued growth in online hate content.

7.4 Quarter IV · October – December

The final quarter recorded **641 verified incidents** — the highest quarterly total of the year — marking a significant intensification of communal tensions.

Table 7.2 — Quarter IV incidents by state

State	Incidents	Share of quarter
Uttar Pradesh	250	39.0%
Maharashtra	100	15.6%
Bihar	70	10.9%
Assam	50	7.8%
Other states	66	10.3%
Total	641	100%

Muslims constituted the overwhelming majority of victims, with Christians and Dalits also affected in smaller numbers; limited reporting for some communities may reflect under-documentation rather than the absence of incidents. A proportion of incidents involved individuals or groups with identifiable political or ideological affiliations, including actors linked to the BJP and organizations such as the Bajrang Dal.

Emerging trends

- **Polarization during key events** — incidents increased during festivals such as Durga Puja and Dussehra, and during periods of political or legal controversy; December recorded the highest monthly concentration.
- **Demolitions and administrative actions** — large-scale demolition drives affecting minority communities in states such as Uttar Pradesh and Assam raised concerns regarding adherence to legal procedures.
- **Media and digital amplification** — online platforms played a significant role in spreading misinformation, including viral narratives and manipulated content.



SECTION 8

8 Spotlight: Disproportionate Impact on the Muslim Community

IN THIS SECTION

8.1 A Sustained, Disproportionate Pattern

8.2 Nature of Crimes

8.3 Political Rhetoric and Leadership

8.4 Lack of Accountability

Sections 3 and 7 set out the overall scale and quarterly progression of hate crimes documented in 2025. This chapter looks more closely at one finding that runs through both: the consistent disproportionate impact on the Muslim community, and the institutional and political conditions that appear to sustain it. Beyond quantitative classification, JEM's framework incorporates survivor testimonies and field-based documentation to contextualize the lived experiences underlying the data.

8.1 A Sustained, Disproportionate Pattern

As detailed in Section 3.1, Muslims accounted for 1,606 verified incidents documented in 2025 — a concentration that held across every quarter of the year rather than being driven by one period or event. This consistency across geography and time points to systemic, recurring targeting rather than isolated or episodic incidents, and raises concerns regarding equality before the law and equal protection of the laws under Article 14 of the Constitution.

8.2 Nature of Crimes

The typology of hate crimes against Muslims in 2025 reveals a multifaceted continuum of harm, including:

- Physical assaults and mob violence;
- Harassment and intimidation;
- Social and economic exclusion;
- Stigmatization through hate narratives.

Such acts produce immediate physical and emotional harm while also contributing to long-term insecurity, alienation, and erosion of social belonging. The classification framework used in this report seeks to combine statistical analysis with documented lived experiences, ensuring a grounded and human-centered understanding of these incidents.

8.3 Political Rhetoric and Leadership

Public institutions and elected representatives play a critical role in shaping social cohesion. During the reporting period, certain forms of public discourse and political messaging were observed to coincide with heightened communal sensitivities. The findings suggest that leadership discourse can either mitigate tensions or contribute to their escalation, highlighting the importance of measured and constitutionally aligned communication.

Provocative statements

During the reporting year, several public statements by political actors — including individuals affiliated with the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) — were identified as containing polarizing or inflammatory elements. Analysis indicates that certain speeches in the first quarter, including those following developments related to the Ram Mandir, were followed by increases in communal tensions, and rhetoric during the third quarter, particularly around election campaigns and religious observances such as Muharram, coincided with localized disturbances and increased online hostility.

Data suggest that approximately 48% of ideologically attributed incidents occurred in temporal proximity to politically charged public statements, and digital monitoring recorded a 30% increase in hate-related online content following high-visibility speeches. While these observations indicate correlation rather than causation, they underline the significant role of public discourse in shaping community dynamics.

8.4 Lack of Accountability

The report identifies persistent gaps in accountability mechanisms. In several jurisdictions, a substantial proportion of cases did not progress beyond initial stages of investigation, limiting access to timely justice. Field observations indicate:

- High rates of stalled investigations or delayed proceedings;
- Limited prosecutorial advancement in a large number of cases;
- Perceptions of selective or uneven enforcement in certain administrative actions.

Strengthening accountability requires impartial enforcement of the law, institutional independence, and transparent oversight — essential for maintaining public trust and upholding constitutional guarantees of equality and justice.



SECTION 9

9

The Rise of Radical Religious Extremist Groups

IN THIS SECTION

9.1 Influence of Organized Groups

9.2 Societal Impact

9.3 Political Ideologies and Hate Crimes

9.4 State Government Responses

India's long-standing tradition of religious pluralism, grounded in constitutional secularism and interfaith coexistence, faced significant strain during 2025 amid the expanding influence of radical religious formations across social, political, and institutional spheres. JEM's consolidated datasets suggest that such violence is not confined to isolated actors but increasingly operates within broader ideological, political, and media ecosystems.

Analysis of JEM's consolidated datasets indicates that a substantial proportion of ideologically attributed hate crimes were associated with groups and narratives aligned with Hindutva-oriented ideology, consistent with the perpetrator-attribution figures presented in Section 3.2. Geographical patterns indicate a concentration of incidents in states governed by the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), suggesting a possible relationship between local political contexts and the prevalence, reporting, or management of such incidents.

Extremist actors frequently invoked narratives of cultural protection, religious identity, and social order to justify vigilantism, moral policing, and collective punishment. JEM's review indicates that inflammatory rhetoric often preceded episodes of violence, while organized mobilization was associated with a notable share of mob-related incidents. The consequences extended beyond immediate physical harm: economic boycotts, social exclusion, and targeted harassment disrupted livelihoods and community stability, with field assessments further indicating psychological distress and instances of displacement.

9.1 Influence of Organized Groups

The contemporary extremist landscape in 2025 appears to be shaped by an interlinked constellation of political actors, ideological organizations, and vigilante groups (incident-level attribution figures are presented in Section 3.2). JEM also recorded incidents involving the actions or inactions of public officials, administrative authorities, or policing institutions, highlighting concerns regarding institutional response.

In Uttar Pradesh, which recorded the highest number of incidents nationally, a significant proportion of cases reportedly involved delayed or limited police intervention, potentially enabling escalation. Comparable patterns were noted in states such as Gujarat, where concerns regarding administrative responsiveness coincided with reported instances of social and economic exclusion. Rhetorical escalation appears to have played an enabling role in certain contexts, with statements by elected representatives or public figures in states such as Maharashtra and Uttarakhand, in some cases, followed by localized increases in tensions or violence.

At the ideological level, cadre-based organizations promoting majoritarian narratives functioned as sites of mobilization and recruitment. Operational violence, however, was more frequently associated with loosely organized vigilante or religious groups; organizations such as the Bajrang Dal and the Vishwa Hindu Parishad were mentioned in connection with incidents involving cow vigilantism, moral policing, and attacks on religious minorities. A range of regional and issue-specific groups also contributed to localized outbreaks, reflecting the decentralized and diffused nature of extremist mobilization, with these formations often sharing narratives centered on cultural identity, exclusionary nationalism, and historical grievance.

9.2 Societal Impact

The societal consequences of radical religious extremism during 2025 were extensive and deeply disruptive. JEM's field-based observations suggest a decline in interfaith trust across affected communities, with hate-driven narratives transforming shared civic spaces into sites of fear and contestation and weakening everyday social cohesion.

Economic consequences were significant, with reported instances of organized boycotts and exclusionary practices leading to livelihood disruptions, particularly among minority-owned businesses. Spatial segregation intensified in some areas as families relocated from violence-prone districts, contributing to patterns of urban clustering and long-term socio-economic fragmentation. Psychological impacts were also notable, with reports indicating trauma and distress among affected communities — including Christians in Odisha, Dalit populations in Bihar, and Adivasi groups affected by land-related conflicts — alongside educational disruptions including school dropouts in vulnerable communities.

Women experienced compounded vulnerabilities, with reported instances of moral policing, coercion related to dress or behaviour, and gendered harassment. The spread of misinformation further eroded public trust, reduced civic participation, and contributed to increased polarization, particularly among younger populations exposed to algorithm-driven content environments.

9.3 Political Ideologies and Hate Crimes

Political ideology emerged as an important factor shaping hate-crime patterns in 2025. Majoritarian narratives, sometimes reflected in political discourse, were associated with a significant proportion of ideologically attributed incidents. Electoral periods appeared to function as critical flashpoints, with states such as Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, and Madhya Pradesh recording increases in incidents during periods of heightened political mobilization.

In Assam, narratives centered on migration, identity, and citizenship contributed to localized tensions, including incidents involving exclusion and displacement. Across states, ideological framing in certain contexts appeared to normalize vigilante actions, discourage institutional intervention, and embolden perpetrators, thereby reinforcing cycles of violence.

9.4 State Government Responses and Institutional Challenges

Challenges in governance and law-enforcement responses significantly affected the handling of extremist violence in 2025. JEM documented instances of alleged state inaction, delayed investigations, and barriers to justice faced by victims. In several states, a substantial proportion of reported cases did not progress to timely investigation or judicial resolution, contributing to perceptions of impunity; institutional challenges were particularly evident in cases involving attacks on religious institutions, where delays in legal proceedings and limited accountability mechanisms were reported.

Online hate further compounded these issues, as digital incitement often spread rapidly and across jurisdictions, complicating enforcement under existing legal and regulatory frameworks.



10

SECTION 10

Conclusion and Way Forward

Findings across the year, the recommendations they support, and the way forward.

This Annual Report reflects a commitment to evidence-based documentation, institutional accountability, and constitutional values. The findings indicate that hate crimes affecting minority communities are not merely isolated incidents but are often shaped by broader structural conditions — including social tensions, political dynamics, and institutional responses.

The report emphasizes that documentation alone is insufficient. Meaningful progress requires continuous examination of the social, political, and institutional factors that enable such patterns to persist; without sustained scrutiny, there is a risk of normalization of violence and erosion of democratic safeguards. A comprehensive response must therefore include:

- **Legal reform** — to strengthen recognition and prosecution of hate crimes;
- **Institutional accountability** — to ensure impartial enforcement of laws;
- **Community-level interventions** — to rebuild trust and counter misinformation;
- **Responsible media practices** — to maintain accuracy and reduce polarization;
- **Educational initiatives** — promoting pluralism and constitutional values.

Equally important is the adoption of survivor-centered approaches, including access to legal aid, psychosocial support, and economic rehabilitation. Justice must extend beyond punishment to include restoration and long-term support for affected individuals and communities.

JEM also recognizes that this report's own documentation reach is uneven across communities. The comparatively low incident counts recorded for Sikhs and Tribal communities in particular reflect current gaps in reporting infrastructure rather than a lower incidence of harm, and closing this gap — through dedicated community-level reporting partnerships and expanded field networks — is a stated priority for the next reporting cycle.

Ultimately, the report calls for renewed commitment to the constitutional principle of fraternity, which underpins mutual respect, equal dignity, and shared citizenship. Addressing hate is not only a matter of law enforcement but also central to preserving democratic institutions and social cohesion.

ON THE RECORD

Justice and Empowerment of Minorities reiterates its commitment to transparency, accountability, and principled engagement. The findings presented in this report aim to contribute to informed dialogue, policy reform, and collective efforts toward a more inclusive and equitable society.

REFERENCE

Appendices

Appendix A · Glossary of Key Terms

Hate Crime

A criminal act motivated wholly or partly by prejudice against a person or group based on religion, caste, ethnicity, gender, or other protected identity — including acts of violence, intimidation, exclusion, or institutional discrimination.

Acts of Hate

Non-physical manifestations of hostility — verbal abuse, hate speech, online harassment, discriminatory conduct, and symbolic violence — that contribute to an environment of fear and exclusion.

State-Sponsored Discrimination

Actions or omissions by government authorities or institutions that result in unequal treatment, denial of rights, or targeted harm — including demolitions, welfare exclusion, and biased enforcement.

Police Atrocities

Instances involving custodial violence, excessive use of force, arbitrary detention, extrajudicial actions, or discriminatory policing practices.

Media Manipulation & Digital Hate

Distortion, misrepresentation, selective omission, or sensationalization of facts that contributes to misinformation, stigma, or incitement; and hate speech, harassment, or incitement occurring on online platforms, including messaging applications and social media networks.

Appendix B · Incident Classification Framework

JEM employs a seven-category framework to classify hate crimes. Each documented incident may fall under one or more categories depending on the nature and impact of harm.

- 1 Acts of Hate
- 2 Acts of Violence
- 3 Attacks on Religious Spaces
- 4 State-Sponsored Discrimination
- 5 Police Atrocities
- 6 Discrimination, Exclusion, and Prejudice
- 7 Media Manipulation and Distortion of Facts

Appendix C · Summary of Verified Incidents (2025)

Community	Incidents
Muslims	1,606
Christians	212
Dalits & Tribals	148
Sikhs	2*
Total verified incidents documented	1,967

**Recorded incidents, with indicators of latent hostility. Consolidates verified data following Case Review Committee validation.*

Appendix D · Quarter-wise Distribution

- **Jan-Mar (387)** — policy implementation, festival overlap, and political rhetoric.
- **Apr-Jun (265)** — demolitions, police misconduct, and institutional discrimination.
- **Jul-Sep (367)** — religious processions, festival-related escalation, and vigilante activity.
- **Oct-Dec (641)** — the most severe quarter; heightened polarization, demolition drives, and media amplification.

Appendix E · Geographical Summary

High-incidence states: Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh. Other affected regions: Assam, Bihar, Uttarakhand, Delhi, Odisha. Reflects patterns of governance, population density, economic stress, and ideological mobilization.

Appendix F · Media Coverage Matrix

Channels assessed: social media, mainstream print, television news, digital news portals. Key findings: significant underreporting across rural and peri-urban regions; selective framing and omission in mainstream outlets; algorithmic amplification and suppression on digital platforms.

Appendix G · Platforms Monitored

X (formerly Twitter), WhatsApp, Telegram, YouTube, Instagram, and Facebook — monitored for language patterns, virality, coordination indicators, and links between online and offline harm.

Appendix K · Acronyms and Abbreviations

JEM — Justice and Empowerment of Minorities · CRC — Case Review Committee · FIR — First Information Report · BNSS — Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita.

Appendix H · CRC Composition

A multidisciplinary body responsible for verification, classification, and ethical review. Expertise: legal analysis, social research, community advocacy, digital forensics, and media analysis. Cases are included only after consensus-based validation.

Appendix I · Limitations & Ethics

Acknowledged limitations: underreporting due to fear, social pressure, and access barriers; limitations in official data availability; challenges in attributing responsibility in opaque investigations. Ethical safeguards include survivor consent, anonymization, and trauma-informed documentation practices.

Appendix J · Legal Framework

Key provisions referenced: Articles 14, 15, 16, 19, and 25 of the Constitution; Indian Penal Code provisions; BNS Section 196; the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act; and the Forest Rights Act and Schedule V protections.

Appendix L · References and Sources

This appendix lists external sources cited by number (e.g., ^[1]) at the corresponding point in the text. JEM's own primary data — incident counts, percentages, and classifications not otherwise cited — is drawn from the Case Review Committee (CRC) database described in Section 2.3.

- [1] Ballard Brief (Brigham Young University), “Violence Against Muslims in India,” issue brief. ballardbrief.byu.edu/issue-briefs/violence-against-muslims-in-india
- [2] United Christian Forum (UCF), Violence Monitor / helpline data on incidents of violence against Christians in India, 2025.
- [3] Citizens for Justice and Peace (CJP), “Hate Crimes on the Rise from 2024–2025.” cjp.org.in/hate-crimes-on-the-rise-from-2024-2025/
- [4] Citizens for Justice and Peace (CJP), documentation of complaints filed with the News Broadcasting & Digital Standards Authority (NBDSA, formerly NBSA) concerning broadcasts by Sudarshan News. cjp.org.in
- [5] JEM Case Review Committee (CRC) database — the primary source, described in Section 2.3, for incident counts, classifications, and percentages presented throughout this report unless otherwise cited.



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A record exists to be cited. Every figure in this report is sourced and dated — documented, verified and maintained independently by JEM.